



Above Selene restaurant in Pyrgos is world-renowned for its authentic Greek cuisine and imaginative use of local ingredients

Left The whitewashed church of Agios Gerasimos in Firostefani ("The Crown of Thira") is dramatically perched on the cliffs of the volcanic caldera



Above The much-prized fava beans of Santorini are simmered until they dissolve into a delicious paste, then eaten with fresh fish or octopus

Santorini Wines

Santorini's mineral-rich *terroir* yields some of the most delicate and distinctive wines in Greece. Around 40 indigenous grape varieties have been cultivated on the island for centuries. The bone-dry Assyrtiko and potent Vinsanto (unique to Santorini) are world-class. Wineries all over Santorini offer tours and tastings. Savor the sunset with oaky Oia Vareli and stuffed vine leaves straight from the surrounding vineyards at the peaceful **Sigalas Winery** (www.sigalas-wine.com) in Baxedes. Or drink in the 360° views with a glass of crisp Nyxteri from the **Santo Cooperative's Enotourism Center** (www.santowines.gr).

The Best Places to Eat Fava

Selene expensive

A mentor to many of Greece's finest chefs, Selene's Yiorgos Hatziyannakis was one of the first restaurateurs to put indigenous dishes such as fava on the menu. But there's nothing rustic about his refined reinterpretation of classic Greek dishes. Since opening Selene in 1986, he has created more than 20 variations of fava: mashed with the crystallized sap of the mastic tree and served with smoked mackerel and almond flakes; fava fritters stuffed with tomato and caper *confit*; fava risotto with grilled sea bass; and even fava ice cream garnished with caper leaves as an intriguing *amuse-bouche*. Other local ingredients are showcased to equally startling effect in dishes such as white eggplant salad with octopus carpaccio and *millefeuille* with cherry tomato marmalade. An informal wine bar below the restaurant serves less experimental but equally sophisticated Greek cuisine at half the price. The restaurant also holds cooking classes once a week.

Pyrgos Village, Santorini; open 7 PM–midnight daily, mid-Apr–mid-Oct; www.selene.gr

Also on Santorini

There are also many less expensive places to try fava in Santorini. At **To Psaraki** (The Little Fish) (www.topsaraki.gr; *moderate*), award-winning chef Thanasis Sfougaris has gone back to basics. His *fava pandremeni*, topped with caramelized onions, is divine, and a phenomenally good buy. **Ta Dichtia** (www.tadichtia.gr; *moderate*) sits on a pretty terrace on Perivolos beach, serving lemony fava, cuttlefish, and bulgur pilaf, and baked grouper. **Kyra Roza** (+30 22860 24378; *inexpensive*) is off the beaten track at Vourvoulos, but attracts off-duty chefs with its creamy fava, crispy red mullet, and mint-flecked *domatokeftedes* (tomato fritters).

Also in Greece

Santorini locals mourned when Chrysanthos Karamolegos, one of Greece's most inventive chefs, moved from the island to Halkidiki. His restaurant **Tomata** (www.sani-resort.com; *expensive*) features fava in unusual ways, such as paired with sea bass in ouzo vinaigrette, or with feta croquettes and watermelon coulis.

Around the World

Greek-American chef Michael Psilakis has single-handedly elevated Greek cuisine several notches. He has moved on from the Michelin-starred Anthos in New York, but you can sample his innovative fava with sea urchin sashimi as part of the post-modern meze at **Eos** at the Viceroy Hotel, Miami, FL (www.viceroymiami.com; *expensive*).